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I. Legislative Reference Files

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Taft-Hartley
1946/12 - 1947/01

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 8870-1-2-3-4
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Executive Council
President, Wm. Green
Secretary-Treasurer, George Meany
A. F. of L. Building, Washington 1, D. C.

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Hutcheson Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.

Second Vice-President, Harvey Brown,
51 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.

Third Vice-President, Joseph N. Weber,
631 Alta Drive, Beverly Hills, Los Angeles, Calif.

Fourth Vice-President, G. M. Bugniazet,
901 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.

Fifth Vice-President, Geo. M. Harrison,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cleveland, O.

Sixth Vice-President, Daniel J. Tobin,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.

Seventh Vice-President, Harry C. Bates,
11 Pleasant St., N. W., Washington, D. C.

Eighth Vice-President, W. D. Mahon,
12th Floor, 1616 Walnut St., Detroit 26, Mich.

Ninth Vice-President, Paul R. Dumont,
400-406 Commerce Bldg., Kansas City, Mo.

Tenth Vice-President, W. D. Mahoney,
Department of Conservation, Indianapolis, Ind.

Eleventh Vice-President, H. C. Bakewell,
901 A. F. of L. Bldg., Washington, D. C.

Twelfth Vice-President, George Harrison,
1015 Broadway, New York, N. Y.

Thirteenth Vice-President, Joseph L. Lewis,
United Mine Workers' Bldg., Washington, D. C.

Washington 1, D. C. December 14, 1946

TO THE OFFICERS OF STATE FEDERATIONS OF LABOR
CITY CENTRAL BODIES, AND
DIRECTLY AFFILIATED LOCAL UNIONS.

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

The 80th Congress will convene in Washington, D. C. beginning January 3, 1947. It is reported that the Members of Congress will be called upon to give consideration to highly objectionable anti-labor legislation. Such legislation, if enacted into law, would vitally affect the economic interests and well-being of the workers of the nation, as well as their freedom and the exercise of all their rights under the Constitution of the United States. I am confident attempts will be made to limit and curtail the exercise of the legitimate functions of labor organizations.

I greatly fear attempts will be made to change the Wagner Labor Relations Act, modify the Norris LaGuardia Anti-Injunction Act, make illegal union shop agreements, restrict the exercise of the rights to strike, subject workers to civil suits for damages for participation in strikes in alleged violation of contracts and, in addition, enact further objectionable labor legislation similar to the notorius Case Bill which was passed at the last session of Congress.

Unfortunately a large number of Congressmen who voted in favor of the passage of the notorious Case Bill at the last session of Congress were re-elected by increased majorities. They will accept their elections as a vindication of their action and as endorsement of the votes they cast in favor of the notorious Case Bill.

I deem it my duty to frankly report to the membership of the American Federation of Labor the legislative outlook for labor during the 80th Congress is a matter of deep concern. We will do everything that lies within

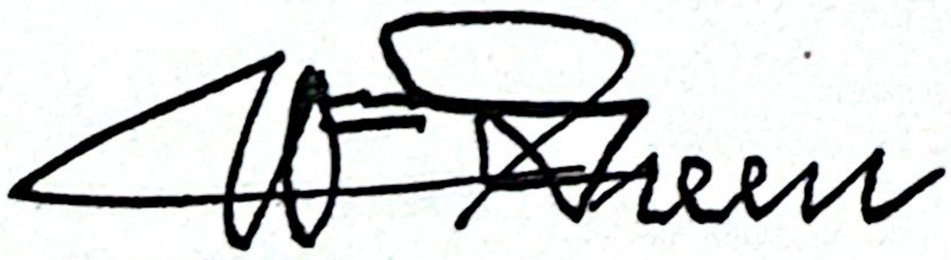
our power to prevail upon the Members of Congress to vote against and oppose objectionable anti-labor legislation, but the facts are that we must deal with the anti-labor and reactionary Members of Congress, elected by the voters, who will pass upon legislation vitally affecting labor at this coming session of Congress. Because of my apprehension and feeling of deep concern over the situation, I am addressing you this communication, earnestly requesting the officers of your organization and the members of the American Federation of Labor in the locality in which your organization functions, to communicate with your representatives in Congress protesting against the enactment of anti-labor legislation and requesting them to stand by labor and vote against anti-labor legislation.

The voice of labor should be heard by the Members of Congress. They should know of your feelings of deep concern and particularly that you are alert -- that you will watch how they vote and if they vote for anti-labor legislation, they cannot expect the support of labor in the event they are candidates for re-election to Congress.

Please bear in mind that every working man and woman and every member of organized labor will be affected deeply by the anti-labor legislation which it is reported will be considered and passed during the 80th Congress which meets early in January 1947. That means in communicating with those who represent you in Congress, you will be appealing in behalf of yourself as well as your fellow workers in all sections of the country.

I respectfully urge you to carry out the suggestions and recommendations herein made immediately. Keep informed as to the action of your representatives in Congress, communicate with them immediately urging them to stand by labor in the exercise of its rights to join and maintain unions and to enjoy in full the freedom and liberty guaranteed by the Constitution of the United States.

Fraternally yours,



President,
American Federation of Labor

Portsmouth Central Labor Union

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

PORTSMOUTH CENTRAL LABOR UNION,
PORTSMOUTH, VIRGINIA.

January 3, 1947.

A RESOLUTION.

WHEREAS: The public press has freely printed, during the past several weeks, much comment on the actions of many reactionary groups in the 80th Congress, as to their intentions of introducing and supporting vicious anti-labor legislation, that will retard or even reverse the normal development and welfare of the American wage earners, both organized and unorganized, if enacted into law, and

WHEREAS: Using this printed comment of our public press as a guide, we can clearly determine that never before in the history of our great nation has the God given freedom and the constitutional rights of more than sixty million American wage earners ever been subjected to such unjust contemplated legislation, and

WHEREAS: With the new year 1947 just beginning, a year that our national economic leaders have predicted to be one of great prosperity for all; to have this prosperity cast aside by our Congress through the enacting of such legislation that can only bring strife, confusion and turmoil, would be poor reward to those who have fought so hard, worked so hard and sacrificed so much to win a war that threatened our freedom and the very constitution that was drafted by other fighters and workers in historical wars and sacrifices of the past, therefore be it hereby

RESOLVED: That the Portsmouth Central Labor Union, appeal to all the United States Senators and Congressmen from the great Commonwealth of Virginia, to stand firmly on the side of all the wage earners of our state and nation by bitterly opposing and defeating, this publicized and contemplated anti-labor and anti-constitutional legislation of the reactionaries, and be it further

RESOLVED: That we send copies of this resolution to all our Honorable members of Congress from Virginia, to Mr. William Green, President of the American Federation of Labor, and to the Press.

This resolution adopted unanimously by the Portsmouth Central Labor Union in regular session January 3, 1947.

Respectfully submitted,
Glenn T. Frey
Glenn T. Frey, Secretary.

To all parent bodies in Virginia and to all affiliated Local Unions of the Portsmouth CLU, we respectfully urge you to adopt this resolution or one similar and mail copies to those you deem best.

January 6, 1947

Honorable Fred A. Hartley, Jr., Chairman
Committee on Education and Labor
House Office Building
Washington, D. C.

Dear Mr. Chairman:

I wish to enter a formal request that I be notified when your Committee takes up proposals affecting labor, as we wish to have an opportunity to present our viewpoints upon all such matters.

With congratulations upon your ascendancy to the Chairmanship of the Committee and with kind personal regards

Sincerely,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

H:s
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Labor Legislation

SANTA CRUZ CENTRAL LABOR COUNCIL

Santa Cruz, California

January 6, 1947

Honorable Robert A. Taft, Chairman
Senate Committee on Labor and Public Welfare
The Capitol
Washington, D. C.

Dear Mr. Chairman:

I should appreciate being advised when legislative proposals affecting labor are to be considered by your committee as we wish to present the viewpoint of the American Federation of Labor upon all such matters.

With kindest regards

Sincerely,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

H:s
opiu-2

Mr. William Green

Mr Edward J & Sullivan
8215 Ingleside
Chicago Ill

William a Green

President a F

RECEIVED
JAN 10 1917

Dear Sir :

as a member of the
C-t-u-a-f-h am deeply
Concerned at organized labor
apparently waiting until
it is too late do something
in a public spirited way
against all the crippling
legislation being Cooked up
in Washington cant understand
why the A f of L waited until
all these enemies got in
Office — why didnt they

organize as a united front
to keep them out - now they are
in - the first bill on the agenda
"Crippling Legislation against Closed
Shop, union shop, maintenance
of membership" they are the
very backbone of organized
Labor as it stands to-day and
any laws to eliminate same
will reduce labor power to
almost "nil" Why dont you
start a National Campaign
against such laws and educate
the General public on the
true meaning union Shop
Closed Shop etc show many
rank & file understand
that it cost labor millions
hard earned dollars to enable
union negotiate raise protect
seniority better working conditions
in general and that a lot of free

riders demand representation
on the same scale as union
members paying freight and
these very free riders that
wont join Chamber could not
represent themselves. only one
of many features a law
against maintenance of membership
should be illegal national scope
Why couldnt it effect motor clubs
all sorts of Lodges of all
denominations etc why should
also private clubs etc
anyone have to a member gain
advantage to membership
same should apply as to labor
dont want be member certain
organization but would like same
advantages members that organization
obtain. Hand Armed Cap think
over + do something J E Mulvaney

Mr Meeking

Meets Every Friday Evening at I.O.O.F. Hall, 8:00 P. M.

SANTA CRUZ CENTRAL LABOR COUNCIL

AFFILIATED WITH THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR
THOMAS H. DRANE, SECRETARY-TREASURER
I.O.O.F. HALL, 109 PACIFIC AVENUE
SANTA CRUZ, CALIFORNIA

Jan 12,1947

RECEIVED
JAN 21 1947

Mr. William Green
President American Federation of Labor

Dear Sir and Brother;

Your letter requesting that we try to prevail upon our Representative, Congressman Jack Anderson, and Senators Downey and Knowland of California, and our State Representatives, to go easy on Anti-Labor Legislation will be complied with.

We hope that we will be successful in securing their Cooperation, because our Council realizes that Industrial Economy upset will result if these " Unconstitutional Labor Bills", which are restrictive to Union Labor are passed. The Legislators must surely know this without Union-Men " educating them to this fact.

What we are concerned about is What Comes After, and just what Organized Labor will, and should plan for the future. Are we to continue following the Policy of Tweedledee and Tweedledum, or attempt (win or lose) sometime, somehow, to get real labor legislators, elected from the ranks of our labor army, this I feel sure is a matter for the deep consideration of all labor, as they want a real democracy, based o fact, and devoid of illusions.

Fraternally yours,

Thomas H. Dr

Secretary-Treasurer, Santa Cruz Central Labor Council

Original delivered to Mic. Ford
at 10:45 Jan. 15, 1947.

January 13, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
901 Massachusetts Avenue, N. W.
Washington, D. C.

Dear Mr. Green:

At a meeting, January 9, 1947, of the National Joint Legislative Conference of the American Federation of Labor and the Railroad Brotherhoods, with fifty-four representatives and Assistant Secretary of Labor Phil Hannah present, the legislative situation in the Eightieth Congress was considered and discussed from every angle.

All present were unanimous in the opinion that the dangerous situation confronting Labor was most acute and that every possible effort should be made to counteract the adverse attitude of the membership of the new Congress.

The Congressional membership generally seems to be of the opinion that they were mandated by the last election to enact anti-labor legislation and unless some action is taken immediately to counteract these opinions, many drastic anti-labor laws will be enacted.

The members of the National Joint Legislative Conference of the A. F. of L. are engaged in combating the present anti-labor trends in Congress, but realize that their efforts alone will not succeed and for the first time in the fifteen years of the Conference's existence are requesting assistance.

It is fully realized that the situation is desperate unless members of Congress are made to realize that the November elections were not an anti-labor mandate.

It will be helpful in bringing them to this realization if communications are received from their constituents to the contrary and, therefore, the following suggestions are made to the Executive Council of the American Federation of Labor:

1. Send another letter immediately to National and International Unions, Departments, State Federations of Labor and Central Labor Unions.

2. Call into conference immediately the officers of all Departments, National and International Unions, and State Federations of Labor.

3. Request Departments, International and National executives to aid all possible and assign their organizers to visit all Central Labor Unions and Locals in their districts, explain the situation and request individual members to write their Congressmen and Senators protesting enactment of anti-labor legislation.

4. Request all State Federation of Labor executives to visit all their affiliates and do likewise.

5. Assign all A. F. of L. Organizers to the same work.

6. Delegate President Green or one alternate Executive Council member, with full authority, to testify before Congressional committees on all anti-labor bills.

7. Consider calling in qualified men from some states to make special contacts with members of Congress from their states.

This matter, in the opinion of all the members of the Conference, is vital and prompt action imperative.

A copy of the Minutes of the January 9 meeting referred to is attached.

Fraternally yours,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman

E. C. Hallbeck, Secretary
National Joint Legislative Conference of the
American Federation of Labor and the
Railroad Brotherhoods

Rec'd from
Mr. Green
1/21/47
Sent

January 17, 1947

TO THE OFFICERS OF NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL UNIONS,
THE DEPARTMENTS OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR,
STATE FEDERATIONS OF LABOR, CITY CENTRAL BODIES AND
FEDERAL LABOR UNIONS

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

The 80th Congress of the United States convened on January 3, 1947. As indicated by press reports, radio commentators and through other public agencies, a number of anti-labor measures have been introduced into the Congress of the United States. A bill making closed shop contracts illegal was introduced by Senator Ball of Minnesota. A measure sponsored by Senators Taft, Ball and Smith, similar in many respects to the highly objectionable Case Bill which passed at the last session of Congress but which was vetoed by the President of the United States, was introduced. In addition measures designed to prohibit national industry agreements and delay in inaugurating strikes have been introduced.

This anti-labor legislation is of tremendous importance to every working man and woman in the United States. It is clearly evident that even though we mobilize every ounce of influence and energy at our command in opposition to the enactment of this anti-labor legislation, that we will find it tremendously difficult to prevent the enactment of anti-labor legislation at this session of Congress.

Unfortunately a large number of the members of the last Session of Congress who voted for the notorious anti-labor Case Bill and whose records in support of said bill were sent to all state federations of labor, city central bodies and affiliates, were re-elected to the 80th Congress by decisive majorities. These members of Congress interpret their re-elections to Congress as an endorsement of their votes for the

notorious anti-labor Case Bill.

We are doing all that lies within our power here in Washington to prevent the enactment of highly objectionable anti-labor legislation. We have organized our legislative representatives here and all are working diligently and strenuously in an effort to prevail upon the members of Congress to oppose and defeat vicious anti-labor legislation. But this will not be enough. We must have the support of the members of our unions in all the Congressional Districts and the states throughout the nation.

For that reason I am again appealing to the millions of the members of the American Federation of Labor to respond, as they have never responded before, to our appeal for help and assistance. You can help greatly if the individual members of unions in the different Congressional Districts and all their friends will communicate with their representatives in Congress, calling upon them to oppose vicious anti-labor legislation. I urge this be done in a large and vigorous way.

The officers of state federations of labor, city central bodies and local organizations can help by holding meetings, pointing out the urgent need for members of unions to communicate with their representatives in Congress as herein set forth. Mass meetings in the different states and Congressional Districts ought to be held. Strong resolutions should be adopted and forwarded to representatives in the House of Representatives and in the United States Senate. Keep up the correspondence with your representatives in Congress. Send communications periodically and as often as possible to your representati in Congress urging them to vote against vicious anti-labor legislation.

I appeal to you -- organize your forces as herein suggested for service and assistance. Let each individual member of a union and all his friends measure up to the requirements of the situation. Let each do his part by communicating, as I have herein requested, with members of Congress urging them to stand with labor and i opposition to vicious anti-labor legislation. This is your fight! If this anti-labor legislation is passed it will hurt you. It will shackle and limit the exercise

of freedom and of rights which we have always enjoyed and which are guaranteed in the fundamental law of the land.

In responding to this appeal, you will be serving yourself, helping your families, protecting your union and promoting your economic, industrial and social welfare. It is not so much a fight for someone else as it is a fight for yourself. Please appreciate the urgency of the situation, the need for aggressive action as herein requested and in response to this appeal regarding the needs of the situation act vigorously, unitedly and individually in every Congressional District throughout the nation.

Fraternally yours,

President,
American Federation of Labor

P. 3
ds
January 17, 1947

From the American Federation of Labor
Information and Publicity Service

FOR RELEASE ON DELIVERY
(Expected at 2 P.M., EST., Jan.31, 1947)

file copy

Following is text of the address delivered today by President William Green of the American Federation of Labor at the annual conference of the United States Conference of Mayors at the Statler Hotel here:

In speaking to you on this important occasion I am conscious of the practical understanding each of you possess of the economic situation prevailing, of the causes of industrial unrest and of the need for close management-labor cooperation in the cities throughout the nation. You are practical men and each of you are called upon to deal with difficult industrial problems which arise in the cities from which you come in a constructive and practical way. We shall now ask ourselves a question -- what are the causes of industrial unrest, economic dislocation and social disturbances which have taken place particularly during the early reconversion period. In making answer to this question one must not only take into account the economic changes which have taken place, but in addition, human nature and its reaction to said changes in order to arrive at a correct understanding of the causes herein referred to.

Ever since the Japanese delivered a cowardly attack against the United States at Pearl Harbor we have been passing through emergency periods. The people of our great country have not been privileged to live the normal way of life which was followed prior to the Japanese attack at Pearl Harbor. We must wait with patience until we return to the normal way of life before we can expect the people of our country to think and act in normal terms and pursue the normal way of life. During the great war emergency we centered our efforts toward the realization of one purpose and one objective -- the winning of the war. Labor as a group set a high standard during that period. It reached new heights of production. It gave the President of the United States a no-strike pledge and maintained it in an almost perfect and complete way. The great army of production responded to every call for service and increased service. No workers in any other country in the world or at any period in the world's history measured up to the standard set by the workers of America during the world war period.

Then came the reconversion period -- the war over. A new change in thinking. The minds of the workers of our Nation were seriously affected by the tide of rising prices which affected them very greatly and their standard of living during the re-conversion period. They were the victims of black market operations, of a complete changed economy with its inflationary effects. How could men thus affected think and act in normal terms? These facts must be taken into account when we survey what has taken place during the reconversion period. Now we are moving rapidly into full production and back into a normal way of life and normal living. I am confident that the working men and women of the Nation will adjust themselves in a most commendable way to the change from the war emergency and reconversion period back to the normal way of living.

It is completely unfair and unintelligent to blame the postwar strikes on an alleged break-down in collective bargaining. No such breakdown took place. On the contrary, the great majority of the unions affiliated with the American Federation of Labor, which have enjoyed long experience in collective bargaining and have established healthy and cooperative relationships with management, were able to negotiate new contracts for higher wages despite the abnormal times.

Let me emphasize right here that those wage increases were negotiated without strikes and without forcing automic price increases. It was not until the Federal Government stepped in a year ago with a new wage formula which permitted matching price increases that the "bulge" came which finally destroyed our national defenses against uncontrolled inflation.

Now that Government controls have been abandoned, the economic pressure for higher wages still stands as the foremost cause

of labor-industrial disputes because the cost of living is still going up. You will remember that when industrial leaders campaigned for the elimination of price controls they promised that the end of such controls would result in a wide expansion of production which would promptly cause reductions in prices. That promise has not yet been kept. The few drops in prices which have occurred have been mostly in luxury items which workers' families could never afford to buy anyhow. I believe that prices will eventually be forced down by increasing production, but until that time we may as well face the fact that workers will be forced to seek higher wages.

The Bureau of Labor Statistics estimates that 90 per cent of the strikes which took place last year resulted from labor-management disputes over wages and working conditions.

At this point let me ask you a plain and simple question. How many of the bills that have been introduced in this session of Congress for the professed purpose of bringing about industrial peace actually attempt to solve the vexing wage-price problem which is the basic cause of most strikes?

Can you name a single one?

Suppose we take some of the most highly advertised new legislative proposals before Congress and subject them to this acid test.

There are bills to abolish the so-called closed shop and all other forms of union security; bills to subject unions to court injunctions; bills to make unions liable to damage suits in the courts; bills to prohibit industry-wide collective bargaining; bills to punish unions for jurisdictional strikes and secondary boycotts and bills subjecting unions to prosecution for alleged unfair labor practices.

In vetoing the old Case Bill last June, President Truman said he had considered whether it would have prevented or shortened the strikes which had occurred in the preceding few months. "Judged solely from this standpoint," the President said, "I am sure any fairminded man would have to admit that it would have failed completely."

I say to you now that the same verdict must be rendered on the new versions of the Case Bill and on the whole conglamoration of wild and wooly, ill-considered and oppressive anti-labor bills now flooding the Congressional hoppers.

Each and every one of them will fail completely to reduce or prevent strikes because they ignore the basic causes of strikes, and because they are directed primarily toward weakening, restricting or punishing the trade union movement.

In his annual message to Congress a few weeks ago, President Truman said: "We must remember, in reviewing the record of disputes in 1946, that management shares with labor the responsibility for failure to reach agreements which would have averted strikes."

The trouble with the legislation we are reviewing here is that it deliberately forgets this important point.

In the name of labor peace, the most reactionary elements in our economic life and their Congressional supporters are attempting to suppress the democratic right of the nation's workers to band together through their trade unions for effective protection of their economic freedom and economic progress.

I predict that if such measures are enacted the result inevitably will be industrial warfare rather than peace.

Let me add another note of warning. Toryism breeds Communism. If our Government turns to the right and attempts to oppress labor, it will only drive labor to the left. Nor can the leaders of industry in America afford to follow the same course as the Tories of England. They regulated, regimented and exploited labor in the name of free enterprise. Now the workers of England have abandoned that kind of free enterprise and have embraced socialism. Do you doubt that the same thing could happen here? Is it

inconceivable that American workers might be driven to the same course under similar provocation?

The strategy of the Tories in America is so obvious that one can almost hear them thinking aloud. They are saying to themselves: "The people of the country are upset. Congress is in a mood for action. Let's take advantage of it. Let's say we are liberal and perhaps people will believe it. Let's say allwe want is to restore a balance of power between labor and management. And let's lynch labor in the process".

To my mind that sums up the so-called "new" and so-called "liberal" program which the National Association of Manufacturers is advertising so widely in the newspapers.

The American Federation of Labor believes sincerely in the free enterprise system. Our entire record, going back more than sixty-five years, proves that. We have never encouraged, appeased or tolerated Communism. On the contrary, as long as I can remember, the American Federation of Labor has stood as an immovable and impenetrable bulwark against Communist attempts to invade the labor movement in this country. We have challenged the Communists at every turn and we have defeated their repeated efforts to bore from within our organization. We have never been forced to resort to double-talk to cover up our position on this issue. First, last and all the time, the American Federation of Labor stands for free enterprise and against totalitarianism in all its obnoxious forms, including Communism.

But we do not believe that free enterprise is a one way street. We do not believe industry can enjoy the benefits of the free enterprise system without according equal benefits to labor.

In my opinion, anti-labor legislation of the type now pending in Congress would be the first step toward wrecking the free enterprise system in America. Its purpose is to destroy the free enterprise of labor. Its effect would be to push the Government right into the middle of every labor-management dispute. Some industrial leaders, who were most vociferous in demanding the abolition of wartime Government controls, are eagerly anticipating these new Government controls. They think the legislation is so one-sided that business would benefit. But let me remind them that once the entering wedge is achieved, Government controls will be applied against private industry as well as against labor.

I am convinced that Government intervention will never improve labor-management relations. I am equally certain that the only way to substitute industrial peace for industrial warfare in our country is for American labor and American industry to do it themselves. It is their problem. They know more about it than any outsiders. It is also their responsibility and obligation to solve that problem if they hope to preserve a free way of life in America.

Now when the arguments get to this point, the opponents of labor usually come up with the charge that labor rejects all legislative remedies but never suggests any alternative solution that is more practical. That charge is untrue.

Labor has a remedy. It is neither revolutionary, nor complicated, nor difficult. In fact it is very simple. It can be summed up in a single phrase -- true and free collective bargaining.

In his "State of the Union" message to Congress, President Truman declared that free collective bargaining "is still the national policy" and "should continue to be the national policy."

To a large extent that statement cannot be challenged. There are more than 50,000 collective bargaining agreements in effect throughout our nation today, negotiated and signed without strikes. Despite their repeated recurrence and dangerous consequences, strikes and lockouts still happen in only a tiny minority of cases.

It is my considered opinion that in most cases collective bargaining breaks down when it is not sincerely or intelligently practiced. Some employers think they are fulfilling their obligation to bargain collectively merely by sitting down in the same room with a labor representative and vetoing every suggestion for a compromise. Some labor representatives think they have done their duty in collective bargaining by making an extreme demand and

refusing to consider any alternative from the other side. Gentlemen, that is not collective bargaining. The whole essence of collective bargaining is a give-and-take spirit -- a willingness to cooperate that is backed up by a determination to find a basis of accommodation rather than an excuse for a quarrel.

Now there are some human factors which occasionally disrupt collective bargaining. Greed, anger, stubbornness and cupidity are frailties which have not yet been entirely eliminated from the human race. They manifest themselves occasionally in labor-management negotiations, as well as in any other forms of human endeavor. That is when outside assistance becomes necessary to prevent collective bargaining from breaking down. That is why we need mediation and conciliation. In fact, we need a great deal more of it than can now be provided by the limited resources of the Department of Labor.

I do not, however, believe that the Federal Government should intervene in the collective bargaining process beyond the stages of conciliation and mediation. Certainly we have learned in recent years that fixed Government wage formulas and compulsory Government arbitration, such as was practiced by the National War Labor Board, are a grave mistake. We cannot operate a free economy in peacetime with such regulatory machinery.

In fact, I would like to see more emphasis placed on the need for settling labor-management disputes locally, instead of in Washington. You, the Mayors of our great industrial cities, have a great opportunity now to promote the cause of industrial peace in this regard. Some cities have managed to remain practically free from strikes because of constructive community leadership in preventing collective bargaining from breaking down. These cities have pioneered successfully in enlisting the services of outstanding representatives of management, labor and the public in the community for conciliation, mediation and voluntary arbitration.

Every strike is settled eventually, one way or another. The best interests of all concerned, including the public, are promoted when the dispute is settled before a strike occurs. This can be accomplished successfully only by voluntary methods, not by compulsion. And I am convinced that such voluntary methods function more effectively at the local level, right at the scene of the dispute, than when the issues are transported for determination to some Federal bureau in Washington.

Of course, collective bargaining, in and of itself, will not prevent strikes unless it is sincerely accepted and universally applied. As long as large numbers of employers give only lip service to collective bargaining and exert their main effort toward getting rid of unions, bitter industrial strife will continue.

It is about time that management realized that unions are here to stay and that oppression will only make them stronger and more aggressive. It is about time that management, which has made such remarkable progress in perfecting manufacturing and sales techniques, devoted a little common-sense thinking to the improvement of labor relations. Any employer who is fair and honest in his dealings with his employes will earn their respect and loyalty and the full cooperation of the union which represents them. Whenever you find a plant with a long history of continuing labor trouble, you will likewise find that the employer is not playing square with his help.

It seems to me that the employer should wake up to the fact that the workers in his plant are his help, they want to help and that they can help most effectively in producing more and in saving more when they are organized into a union of their own choice.

Labor relations are only a form of human relations. There is no way of improving human behavior merely by passing a law. Good labor-management relations must be based on friendship and respect and these must be earned through patience, understanding and fair dealing.

I do not say that labor is always right and that all unions are perfect. Far from it. The character of a union,

MISSOURI
STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

January 22, 1947

Dear Mr. Meany:

Set of anti-Labor bills herewith as requested.

Analysis of these bills will be along shortly.

Sincerely

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

oeiu-2

Fraternally yours,

P. J. Wood, President,
Mo. State Federation of Labor.

LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE
R. F. WOOD, CHAIRMAN
ANTHON ROGERS
JOHN W. KRAMER
FRANK J. MURPHY, SECRETARY

MISSOURI
STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

AFFILIATED WITH THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR
LEGISLATIVE OFFICE
HOTEL GOVERNOR
JEFFERSON CITY, MO.

January 29.1947

Mr,Wm Hushing, Chairman,
National Legislative Committee,
American Federation of Lhbor,
A.F.of L. Building,
Washington, D.C.

Dear Bill;

Will you please forward me the important anti-labor bill that have been introduced in the United States Congress.

We are going to have a tough time in our attempt to prevent the passage of some very bad legislation during the Mo.General Assembly.

Inclosed find one of them the most vicious as yet presented, and there are more to come I am informed. A hearing will held on SB No.79 whihin the next two weeks.

With kindest personal regards,

I am,

Fraternally yours,

R. F. Wood

President,
Mo.State.Federation of Labor.

WESTERN UNION

JOSEPH L. EGAN
PRESIDENT

SYMBOLS
DL = Day Letter
NL = Night Letter
LC = Deferred Cable
NLT = Cable Night Letter
Ship Radiogram

The filing time shown in the date line on telegrams and day letters is STANDARD TIME at point of origin. Time of receipt is STANDARD TIME at point of destination

RECEIVED
JAN 30 1947

LD27 RN GOVT NL PD

WASHINGTON DC JAN 29 1947

MR WILLIAM GREEN PRESIDENT

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR, WASHINGTON DC

THE SENATE COMMITTEE ON LABOR AND PUBLIC WELFARE HAS TENTATIVELY SCHEDULED YOU TO TESTIFY AT ITS CURRENT HEARINGS AT TEN A.M. ON TUESDAY FEBRUARY 18TH ON THE GENERAL QUESTION OF LABOR RELATIONS. YOU ARE BEING ALLOTTED A TOTAL OF TWO AND ONE-HALF HOURS FOR THE PURPOSE OF MAKING YOUR APPEARANCE. YOU SHOULD PLAN ON DEVOTING ONE-HALF OF THE TIME TO ORAL PRESENTATION AND ALLOW ONE-HALF OF IT FOR QUESTIONS BY THE MEMBERS OF THE COMMITTEE. IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECENT REORGANIZATION PROGRAM YOUR COMPLETED BRIEF MUST BE FILED WITH THE COMMITTEE CLERK 24 HOURS BEFORE YOUR SCHEDULED APPEARANCE. PLEASE SUBMIT 75 COPIES OF YOUR BRIEF AT THAT TIME TO SUPPLY THE COMMITTEE MEMBERS AND THE PRESS. YOUR ORAL TESTIMONY SHOULD THEN SUMMARIZE YOUR VIEWS AND COMMENTS ON THE MATTERS UNDER CONSIDERATION. THE BRIEF YOU SUBMIT MAY BE AS COMPREHENSIVE AS YOU DESIRE BUT YOUR ORAL TESTIMONY MUST BE CONFINED TO THE TIME ALLOTTED. PLEASE WIRE CONFIRMATION TO THE COMMITTEE CLERK IMMEDIATELY.

ROBERT A TAFT, CHAIRMAN

SENATE COMMITTEE ON LABOR & PUBLIC WELFARE

255AM

I made these arrangements Jan 27 today with Mr. Rodgers, Clerk to the Com. and advised the Com. Mr Green would appear Feb 18th 1947

THE COMPANY WILL APPRECIATE SUGGESTIONS FROM ITS PATRONS CONCERNING ITS SERVICE

MEMORANDUM

To: President Green
From: W. C. Hushing
Date: January 31, 1947

I have made arrangements for you to be the first Labor witness before the Senate Committee on Education and Public Welfare on pending labor bills.

You are to appear at 10 A. M., February 18, 1947, and you are allotted two and one-half hours. You must file a brief at least twenty-four hours prior to your appearance.

The Committee wishes seventy-five copies of the brief and a like number of a summary. The brief is not to be read to the Committee, but you are to speak on the bills for one and a quarter hours, without interruption, and then there will be an hour and a quarter of questioning.

Phil Murray will be the next witness the afternoon of February 18.

H/a

January 31, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
Alcazar Hotel
Miami, Florida

Dear Mr. Green:

On January 27th I made arrangements for you to be the first Labor witness before the Senate Committee on Education and Public Welfare on pending Labor bills.

You are to appear at 10 A. M., February 18, 1947, and you are allotted two and one-half hours. You must file a brief at least twenty-four hours prior to your appearance.

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Phil Murray will be the next witness the afternoon of February 18.

I have been in close contact with the House Committee for sometime past but I cannot make your arrangements for a day or two in regard to testimony there as the Committee has not decided exact procedure to be followed as yet. Immediately upon arrangements being concluded, I shall give you a memorandum similar to the above.

I have been doing my best to arrange matters in as favorable a way as possible, insofar as the new House Committee staff is concerned. I am endeavoring to get a competent labor adviser appointed who is O. K. to us, and am trying to get appointed Don Loudon who, as you know, has been adviser to

the National Republican Committee.

The minority members of the House Labor Committee, under the new Reorganization Act, were to be allowed a labor adviser also, as under the Legislative Reorganization Act Committee staffs are increased to approximately ten persons, carrying within that number expert technical advisers.

The Republicans being in the majority, of course, have the say in regard to most of the appointments and the Democrats are to be allowed but one adviser. They agreed to let me select this man and it was O. K. with both the Chairman of the Committee, Congressman Fred Hartley of New Jersey, and the ranking minority member, John Lesinski, who is an old-time friend of ours, as you know.

On yesterday the Democrats learned that if they appointed a labor adviser that they would not have any stenographic services detailed to them, so they decided to take instead of one man, a labor advisor at $10,000, an assistant clerk at $7,200 and a competent stenographer at $4800 per annum.

Congressman Lesinski asked me if it would be agreeable to me to let him keep his present Committee clerk as the assistant clerk and I could select the stenographer. I agreed to this and Miss Ethel Adams, who has worked in the Legislative Committee for years, is to start with the Committee next Monday. This is also being done with the full approval of Chairman Hartley and Congressman Lesinski, and she is there to keep us advised on all matters of interest to us.

I feel that Miss Adams is doing us a great service in this matter and I have told her that in the event that she wants to return to work at the Federation at some future date, that her wish will be granted. I want you and Mr. Meany to confirm this.

Congressman Geelan of Connecticut, who was defeated in the last election and who is an ardent CIO supporter and very far to the left, has been very active in an endeavor to secure the position as labor adviser to the House Labor Committee, but I have his appointment blocked absolutely and positively.

EWJ:l
cslu-26
Enc.

Hope the foregoing meets with your approval, and with best wishes, I am

Sincerely yours,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

H/a

1897 - Fifty Golden Years - 1947

Amalgamated Meat Cutters and Butcher Workmen of North America

AFFILIATED WITH A.F.OF L.

EARL W. JIMERSON, President
PATRICK E. GORMAN, Secretary-Treasurer

GENERAL OFFICES: ROOM 700-160 N. LASALLE ST.
CHICAGO 1, ILLINOIS

January 31, 1947

RECEIVED
FEB 1 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A.F. of L. Building
Washington, D.C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

I acknowledge receipt of your circular letter dealing with anti-labor legislation, in which you request that we send to all of our Local Unions a letter urging them to contact their Congressmen and Senators in an effort to defeat this legislation.

Attached is a copy of letters that were sent previous to the time that we received your letter. We have also notified all of our International representatives that when they are in a city and the Central Body Trade Labor Union has a meeting, to attend the meeting and to encourage the delegates from the various local unions to have their membership write their Congressmen and Senators. We have likewise instructed them to do the same in attending all local union meetings.

With kind personal regards, I remain,

Fraternally yours,

Earl W. Jimerson

PRESIDENT

EWJ:lms
oeiu-28
Enc.

VICE-PRESIDENTS

JOHN MALONE, Fort Worth, Tex.
M. S. MAXWELL, San Francisco, Calif.
T. J. LLOYD, Salt Lake City, Utah
JOSEPH BELSKY, New York City, N. Y.
R. EMMETT KELLY, Chicago, Ill.
MARVIN W. HOOK, St. Louis, Mo.
HARRY POOLE, Philadelphia, Pa.
JOSEPH Y. HENDERSON, San Francisco, Calif.
RAY WENTZ, St. Paul, Minnesota

SENATE BILL NO. 79

64TH GENERAL ASSEMBLY

INTRODUCED BY SENATOR MADISON.

Read 1st time January 21, 1947, and 500 copies ordered printed.

ROY D. MILLER, Secretary.

AN ACT

To prevent and settle labor disputes and to promote industrial peace; to create boards of arbitration for the settlement of such disputes; to prescribe the powers and duties of such boards and to provide for the appointment, qualifications and compensation of members of such boards; to prescribe the procedure for the settlement of labor disputes and for arbitration thereof; to require the filing of lists and statements by employer organizations and labor organizations; to define the rights of employees and employers; to regulate the rights of employers and workers or labor organizations to engage in lockouts or strikes; to authorize the governor to seize property when necessary to protect the public welfare in cases of strikes or lockouts and to pay damages for such seizure; to authorize the restraint of certain activities designated as "unfair labor practices"; to provide for the enforcement of liabilities for breach of working agreements or contracts between employers and labor organizations; to authorize labor organizations to sue and be sued in their

Amalgamated Meat Cutters and Butcher Workmen of North America

AFFILIATED WITH A.F.OF L.

EARL W. JIMERSON, President
PATRICK E. GORMAN, Secy-Treas.

GENERAL OFFICES: ROOM 700-160 N. LASALLE ST.
CHICAGO 1, ILLINOIS

January 23, 1947

TO THE SECRETARY OF EACH
OF OUR LOCAL UNIONS

Dear Sir and Brother:

The officers especially of each of our local unions must be ever alert or else the membership of organized labor through the enactment of vicious legislation will receive a terrific drubbing.

With Senator Joe Screwball of Minnesota and others of his ilk in the Congress of the United States and with smaller fry legislators in the various assemblies of our state legislatures the reactionary forces of our nation have in these people tools that will do their every bidding. If "ETERNAL VIGILANCE IS THE PRICE OF SUCCESS", THAT ETERNAL VIGILANCE IS NEEDED NOW.

We have asked our Research Director, Mr. David Dolnick, to prepare a brief and concise analysis of the most important of these laws which the men referred to herein are now trying to foist upon the statute books of our nation and of our several states.

You and we must work with the American Federation of Labor and all decent thinking people to defeat these proposed laws and if they are passed, to have them nullified by the United States Supreme Court.

Mr. Dolnick's brief analysis of the proposed vicious legislation is attached hereto.

With kind personal regards, we remain

Fraternally yours,

ER
OEIU 28
encls.

EARL W. JIMERSON,
President.

PATRICK E. GORMAN
Secretary-Treasurer.

WILL THESE BE OUR FUTURE LAWS?

by

David Dolnick
Research Director

Organized labor is being challenged by forces of reaction. False and exaggerated propaganda is spread throughout our land to undermine the morale of our rank and file members and build up an antagonistic public opinion. Those who have constantly opposed us at every turn and employers who have repeatedly blocked our every effort to raise the standard of living of America's wage earners, have suddenly become the protectors of the rights of the individual.

The program of those who are directing this campaign is now clarified and well under way. If we permit it to continue unchallenged, we jeopardize our economic achievements and return to the days of the sweat shop and the armed private detectives.

Every war plays havoc with the nation's economy. A world war which economically involved every nation and all peoples is bound to leave in its path prejudice, hatred, intolerance and economic devastation throughout many lands. Even though we in the United States have, on the whole, fared better than the peoples of other countries, we are not altogether free from the probabilities of an economic depression.

A new Congress is now in session. At the end of the first week more than one hundred bills have been introduced which directly or indirectly seek to control the free and democratic existence of every legitimate trade union. If any of these should be enacted into law, it will also affect the economic welfare of all wage earners.

In the main, the proposed pending legislation seeks to accomplish seven objectives:

1. Prohibit closed-shop, union-shop, maintenance of membership, and preferential-shop agreements.
2. Amend or emasculate the National Labor Relations Act.

3. Impose directly or indirectly compulsory mediation and compulsory arbitration.
4. Prohibit industry-wide collective bargaining agreements.
5. Provide for a cooling-off period during which time we would not be permitted to call a strike or make any threat of work stoppage.
6. Prohibit secondary boycotts.
7. Compel the registration of trade unions, including the disclosing of such information as officers' salaries and expenses, the manner in which they were elected or appointed, the amount of initiation fees and dues charged, and a financial statement.

The anti-closed shop movement is led by Senator Ball of Minnesota, and he is being supported by Senator Byrd of Virginia, Congressman Miller of Nebraska, Congressman Howard Smith of Virginia and Congressman Hoffman of Michigan. These bills are not ohly contrary to the basic principles of our const itution and interfere with the right of contract, but are anti-democratic and seek to destroy the very principles on which the foundations of our government have been built.

The laws to provide for compulsory mediation and arbitration are sponsored in the main by Senator Taft, with the help and assistance of Senator Ball and others. The most important bill in this category is one entitled "Federal Labor Relations Act of 1947". This bill would propose the establishment of a federal mediation board consisting of five members operating within the Department of Labor which would take over the functions of the Conciliation Service. However, unlike the present practice, this new Board could, on its won motion, intercede in any labor dispute involving the free flow of c ommerce without first being requested to do so by either of the parties. Once the Board took notice of a labor dispute, the parties then would be prohibited from

threatening any work stoppages or strikes until the matter in dispute was resolved. This proposed bill would also permit the unions to sue and to be sued. Such affirmative right granted to employers would probably result in many unjustified legal actions which would accomplish two purposes: (1) it would prevent the union from using its legitimate right to strike for an undisclosed period of time; and (2) it may result in draining the union's treasury so that it could not carry on its functions economically.

Many bills have been introduced which would emasculate the National Labor Relations Act and defeat the very purposes for which it was originally enacted. Others would modify it to a degree where the employer could unduly prolong the certification of a trade union where it represented a majority of employees. Some would also impose penalties upon employees individually and the unions for alleged violations of agreements, and one bill would even extend the prohibitions contained in the Lea Bill (or Petrillo Bill) to all types of business, in spite of the fact that a Federal District Judge recently held the Lea Bill unconstitutional. Many would also specifically prohibit the right of supervisory employees to be represented for purposes of collective bargaining by a trade union or any other organization of its kind.

One of the bills now pending before Congress, also introduced by Senator Ball of Minnesota, would prohibit the execution of collective bargaining agreements where two or more employers and their employees bargain on a nation-wide basis. Senator Ball would have it declared a policy of the United States that the authority of "two or more employers and their employees to bargain collectively to determine the terms and conditions of employment of such employees, should be confined to geographical areas small enough so that all employees and employers concerned will be able to participate directly in the determination of bargaining policies....".

This bill is designed to eliminate the possibility of industry-

PATERSON
JAN 11
9 PM
1947
1

SAVE TH[illegible] EASY WA[illegible]
BUY U.S. BONDS ON
PAYROL[illegible]

THIS SIDE OF CARD IS FOR ADDRESS

W. C. Pursley
901 Massachusetts Ave.
N.W.
Washington D.C.

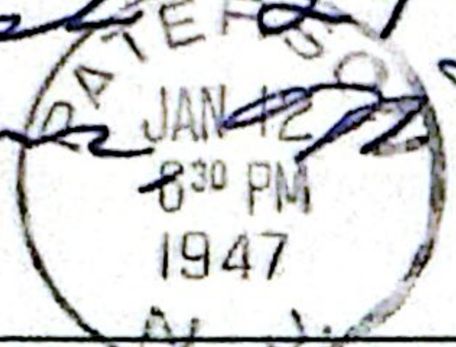
Dear Sir.

Please send me the material you send the congressman and senator.

Sincerely

allan Kaplan
356 - 11th Ave
Paterson 4
N.J.

P. Chlebnikow
424 East 29 St.
Paterson N.J.



THIS SIDE OF CARD IS FOR ADDRESS

W. C. Hushing
901 Massachusetts
Avenue N. W.
Washington 1, D. C.

Jan 10, 1947

Dear Sir:

Please send me all your regular material that you send to the Congressmen and Senators.

Sincerely
Ralph Chekanow
424 East 29 St.
Paterson, N.J.

From the American Federation of Labor
Information and Publicity Service

FOR RELEASE IN TUESDAY A.M. PAPERS, Dec. 17, 1946

Following is text of letter sent today by AFL President William Green to the officers of all State Federations of Labor, City Central Bodies and directly affiliated local unions:

The 80th Congress will convene in Washington, D.C. beginning January 3, 1947. It is reported that the Members of Congress will be called upon to give consideration to highly objectionable anti-labor legislation. Such legislation, if enacted into law, would vitally affect the economic interests and well-being of the workers of the nation, as well as their freedom and the exercise of all their rights under the Constitution of the United States. I am confident attempts will be made to limit and curtail the exercise of the legitimate functions of labor organizations.

I greatly fear attempts will be made to change the Wagner Labor Relations Act, modify the Norris LaGuardia Act, make illegal union shop agreements, restrict the exercise of the right to strike, subject workers to civil suits for damages for participation in strikes in alleged violation of contracts and, in addition, enact further objectionable labor legislation similar to the notorious Case Bill which was passed at the last session of Congress.

Unfortunately a large number of Congressmen who voted in favor of the passage of the Case Bill at the last session of Congress were re-elected by increased majorities. They will accept their elections as a vindication of their action and as endorsement of the votes they cast in favor of the Case Bill.

I deem it my duty to report to the membership of the American Federation of Labor the legislative outlook for labor during the 80th Congress is a matter of deep concern. We will do everything that lies within our power to prevail upon the Members of Congress to vote against and oppose objectionable anti-labor legislation, but the facts are that we must deal with the anti-labor and reactionary Members of Congress, elected by the voters, who will pass upon legislation vitally affecting labor at this coming session of Congress. Because of my apprehension and feeling of deep concern over the situation, I am addressing you this communication, earnestly requesting the officers of your organization and the members of the American Federation of Labor in the locality in which your organization functions, to communicate with your representatives in Congress protesting against the enactment of anti-labor legislation and requesting them to stand by labor and vote against anti-labor legislation.

The voice of labor should be heard by the Members of Congress. They should know of your feelings of deep concern and particularly that you are alert -- that you will watch how they vote and if they vote for anti-labor legislation, they cannot expect the support of labor in the event they are candidates for re-election to Congress.

Please bear in mind that every working man and woman and every member of organized labor will be affected deeply by such anti-labor legislation. That means in communicating with those who represent you in Congress, you will be appealing in behalf of yourself as well as your fellow workers in all sections of the country.

I respectfully urge you to carry out the suggestions and recommendations herein made immediately. Keep informed as to the action of your representatives in Congress, communicate with them immediately urging them to stand by labor in the exercise of its right to join and maintain unions and to enjoy in full the freedom and liberty guaranteed by the Constitution of the United States.

####

Barberton Central Labor Union

660 WEST TUSCARAWAS AVENUE

TELEPHONE SHERWOOD 0346

BARBERTON, OHIO

January 3, 1947

1/13/47
Mr Hamburg

American Federation of Labor
Washington,
D. C.

Att: George Meany, Sec'y.

Dear sir and brother:

The Barberton Central Labor Union, at their last meeting, went on record with the following resolution;

WHEREAS: there are a number of reactionary forces now working against labor, that would abolish unions or hinder them from functioning, by National Legislation;

BE IT RESOLVED; that the Barberton Central Labor Union call all labor unions in Barberton to stand united to combat this anti-labor legislation;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED; that all labor unions be fully informed on all anti-labor Legislation. And
BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED; that the American Federation of Labor stand united with all Americans to combat such legislation, and to fully educate the Public on such matters with a firm and common stand.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED; that a copy of this resolution be sent to all avenues of publication.

Fraternally yours,

BARBERTON CENTRAL LABOR UNION

John O. Weaver

JOW/dls

John O. Weaver, Secretary

RECEIVED JAN 13 1947

"BUY UNION LABEL"

Mr Thornberg Kalamazoo
Mr Representative Michigan
of Labor Rabbi of Beg
and. Labor money Jan 3RD 1946
To AFL officers?

We hear there
$ 10,000 legislative are
people representatives but
what people representative?
can there legislators with
their anti-Labor bill
to penalize, and restrict Labor
Each for de Cadet Called
representative of labor and
for better Wages, hours, and
working Conditions for labor
No they can't they are repre-
-sentative of anti-labor big
money, slave drivers and
profiteers interest to smash labor
It time Rankin Fascist
ant-labor committee which is
really a un-american committee
is abolished Neel

RECEIVED JAN 6 1947

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Executive Council
President, William Green
Secretary-Treasurer, George Meany
A. F. of L. Building, Washington, D. C.

First Vice-President, Florence E. Thorne,
Chesapeake Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.
Second Vice-President, Dan Tobin,
211 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.
Third Vice-President, Joseph D. Keenan,
900 S. Wabash Ave., Chicago, Ill.
Fourth Vice-President, G. M. Bugniazet,
900 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Fifth Vice-President, Geo. M. Harrison,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cleveland, O.
Sixth Vice-President, Charles J. Stohr,
900 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Seventh Vice-President, Harry C. Bates,
901 Pennsylvania Ave., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Eighth Vice-President, M. F. Ahearn,
1734 Penn. Mut. Insurance Bldg., Philadelphia, Pa.
Ninth Vice-President, Daniel J. Tobin,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Tenth Vice-President, Harvey C. Fremming,
Labor Temple, Minneapolis, Minn.
Eleventh Vice-President, W. D. Mahon,
Machinists' Bldg., Washington, D. C.
Twelfth Vice-President, Joseph N. Weber,
901 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.

Secretary-Treasurer, John B. Lewis,
Illinois Bldg., Washington, D. C.

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 8870-1-5-8-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL

Washington 1, D. C.

January 7, 1947

Mr. E. Noel

Kalamazoo, Michigan

Dear Sir:

Receipt is acknowledged of your letter of January 3, which has been referred to our National Legislative Committee. We anticipate many violently anti-labor proposals in the present Congress but sincerely hope that reason will prevail and that no legislation detrimental to labor and the people as a whole will be enacted after our viewpoint has been made known.

With best wishes, I am

Fraternally yours,

William Green

President
American Federation of Labor

Ha
oeiu-2

Feels necessity for enactment of anti-labor legislation due to one sided propaganda — Average member must be made to realize need for determined action — More Pres. Green be asked to call conference of Exec. Council asking heads to detail representatives to work in the grass-roots at home.
no second —

Letters of Pres. Green Dec-14-1923
read by Sec —

A.F.L. Council meets 29th of Dec — preparing report — would take organizers and have them call on all local unions in their territory —

Coleman — Suggests Sec. State Comm on Resolutions A.F.L. Ex Council for March meetings to action Legislative program

Jos B Burns - Suggests Flynn propositions in with scholastic situation in State Legislatures —

Redmon & Fire Fighters - Bills to be introduced to counteract —

Fortu Pratt — Congressmen getting letters from constituents who claim membership org labor requesting "corrective" measures.

Marks - recent motion of Flynn -

Miles committee appointed to formulate

Substitute: Suggest to Green that conference of Int Union Exec be called to meet in Washington - Request them to push their organizers to work in each district. Include. A F L organizers and Coleman suggestion for State Conventions.

Cncn. Green -

Need for coordination & effort to show Congress why we are opposed to these Anti-Labor Laws —

called Sbtb Fed of L. Minn to get in touch with all local unions relative to Sen Ball - Urged letters to Ball condemning his stand — apparently failed to make an impression

Hopes Rep Leaders will reconsider better attitude in view of '48

Will bring entire matter to attn of E.C. on 29

Power to withhold labor will exist despite any legislation enacted - Strong path ahead. Heritage. Need for awakening back Home —

Flynn - Motion - carried unanimously
Wills - Yes-Sec - Comm - ⑤ appt to the
Rec - carried — unanimously

Com. Nushing - ① George - ③ Johnson
② Flynn - ④ Howe -

Adjourn - 1215

Mr. Andrew Cliff Dallmayr
Medigo
JAN 13 1947
Jan 10 1946

To William Green.
and officers

Readers may Anti-Labor
tax and Ball of big money
Senator Ball would try
to destroy the Unions by
partially Limiting & called
-ive Bargaining to bread
Unions which would prevent
any Nation wide organized
strike.

Of Course Unscrupulous Anti-
Labor senators would not limit
the N.A.M the C of C. the Heard
papers and other Chains of anti-
Labor Nationwide papers, the Amer-
-ican Legion, the V.F.W and all
lodge to local unit of course
not only Labor.

E. Pellegrini

LAW OFFICES OF
JOSEPH A. PADWAY
GENERAL COUNSEL
AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

J. A. PADWAY
I. B. PADWAY
HERBERT S. THATCHER
NORA B. PADWAY
HENRY KAISER
JAMES A. GLENN
ROBERT A. WILSON
JACQUELINE WEMPLE

736 BOWEN BUILDING
WASHINGTON 5, D. C.

TELEPHONE REPUBLIC 0717

January 11, 1947

Mr. W. C. Hushing, Chairman
Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor
901 Massachusetts Avenue NW
Washington, D. C.

Dear Mr. Hushing:

We do not get the Bills introduced in Congress dealing with Labor. We could, of course, do so but with my limited staff it would take a good deal of time to segregate the Bills, etc.

I would appreciate it very much if you would procure for me two copies of all Bills dealing with Labor introduced in Congress. We will then proceed to analyze the important Bills and every analysis we make we will see to it that you get a copy. In that way you will be giving us considerable help and we in turn might be affording you a little help -- at least I hope so. I am leaving instructions with my secretary to send one copy to me at Miami during the time I will be there with the American Federation of Labor.

Thanking you for your attention to this matter, I am

Sincerely yours,

Joe Padway

JAP-mmf

JOSEPH A. PADWAY

Mr. Hutcheson

UNITED PACKINGHOUSE WORKERS OF AMERICA

LOCAL No. 4
AFFILIATED WITH THE U. P. W. A. OF THE C. I. O.
432 SOUTH CONCORD PHONE LA SALLE 1410
SOUTH ST. PAUL, MINNESOTA

January 14, 1947

RECEIVED
JAN 21 1947

William Green, Pres.
American Federation of Labor
Washington D.C.

Dear Sir:

The 80th Congress is already preparing itself to completely take away all the gains that organized labor has secured in the last decade. The situation is so critical that it needs the cooperation of all organized labor whether it be CIO, AFL, or Independent. The members of Local #4, United Packinghouse Workers of America, CIO realize that only by joint action can this drive on labor be combated.

Consequently we are asking that a National Labor Conference be called of the above mentioned organizations for the purpose of formulating a joint program to stem off this wave of anti-labor legislation. An attempt to pass legislation that will limit the activities of one organization will inevitably affect all organizations.

Hoping you will give this matter your utmost attention we remain,

Yours very truly,

Mike Yovicson
Mike Yovicson, Pres.

Oscar Krueger
Oscar Krueger, Fin. Sec.

William Brust
William Brust, Rec. Sec.

HARRY F. PETTY, President

EDWARD H. WEYLER, Secretary-Treasurer

KENTUCKY STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

AFFILIATED WITH THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

First Vice-President
A. C. KAISER
Louisville

Second Vice-President
LONNIE WEBSTER
Lexington

Third Vice-President
ELMER ROTHRING
Covington

Fourth Vice-President
MRS. JAMES MARET
Paducan

Fifth Vice-President
JAMES J. JOHNSON
Owensboro

Sixth Vice-President
JOHN E. McKIERNAN
Louisville

Seventh Vice-President
IRA G. THOMPSON
Hopkinsville

Eighth Vice-President
FRANK STARRITT
Corbin

Legislative Committee
ROBT. F. WOERNER, Chairman
Louisville

Telephone JAckson 6189 — LOUISVILLE 2, KENTUCKY — 1402 WASHINGTON BUILDING

January 16, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

Realizing the advantage of knowing the attitude of new members in Congress or in the State Legislature, I furnish you the following information:

Attached are copies of letters, one from Senator Cooper, Congressman Morton and Congressman Meade of Kentucky. Senator Cooper, while a member of the Kentucky Legislature and as Judge in Pulaski County, has a very good record. I think his letter attached is a pretty good one.

Congressman Morton is owner of the Ballard and Ballard Flour Mill in Louisville, one of the first to carry the union label of the American Federation of Labor. Our relations in that plant have been splendid ever since it was organized. I think his letter is very good.

You will note where Congressman Howes Meade refers to himself as "we friends of Labor". Might I advise that the Labor Movement in his district thinks a lot of him.

I am furnishing you these letters in case either of these three members of the 80th Congress get cross-wise in order that our A. F. of L. lobbyists may call their attention to the statements attached.

With best wishes, I am

Fraternally yours,

Edward H. Weyler,
Secretary-Treasurer

EHW:bw

COPY

CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES
House of Representatives

Washington, D.C.

January 8, 1947

Mr. Edward H. Weyler,
Kentucky State Federation of Labor
1402 Washington Building
Louisville 2,Kentucky

Dear Ed:

I have your letter of January 3 and I agree with the statements you have made therein. In my campaign for Congress, I pointed out the fact that little or no publicity had been given to the 79,000 labor management contracts made without strike or work stoppage since VJ Day.

Regardless of our own feelings as practical men, you and I know that there is going to be some labor legislation passed within the next few months. I find a strong feeling here especially among the newly elected Republicans to keep this legislation from being punitive or in any way curtailing the freedom of the rank and file of labor.

It now appears that I will not get to Kentucky this weekend but on my first visit, I will arrange a conference with you.

With best wishes,

Sincerely yours,

(s) Thruston
Thruston B.Morton

TBM:V

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UNITED STATES SENATE
Washington, D.C.

January 13, 1947

Mr. Edward H. Weyler,
Secretary-Treasurer
Kentucky State Federation of Labor
1402 Washington Building,
Louisville 2, Kentucky

Dear Mr. Weyler:

I am very glad that you have given me your general viewpoint with respect to labor legislation which will come before the 80th Congress.

You, of course, are familiar with my past record in this field and with the ideas which I expressed in my speech at Owensboro. While I have indicated the desirability of certain changes or additions to existing law, I have not yet committed myself to any specific proposal along these lines or to any of the other proposals which have been laid before the Congress. I will not favor what seem to me to be punitive or coercive measures, and will in every case be guided solely by what I believe to be in the public interest. I wish to have the advantage of all the information I can obtain, and I am sure that you know that your suggestions on any specific matter will be appreciated.

I think I realize something of the extent of Labor's struggles, the rights which it has won, and its great contribution to the war effort. I will bear these in mind.

I wish to thank you again for writing to me.

With kindest regards,

Sincerely yours,

(s)John S.Cooper

COPY

CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES

House of Representatives

Washington, D. C.

January 9, 1947

Mr. Edward H. Weyler,
Secretary-Treasurer
Kentucky State Federation of Labor
1402 Washington Building
Louisville2, Kentucky

Dear Mr. Weyler:

In answer to your letter of January 3, 1947, in regard to the possibility of anti-labor legislation being passed by the 80th Congress, I wish to state that it is my belief that we friends of labor will be able to prevent any and all drastic labor measures that come before the Congress. It seems quite evident that there will be some mild, regulatory, but non-punitive legislation that will pass. I am certainly in hopes that none will pass that will in any way injure the laboring men and women in our country.

It is always a pleasure to hear from you.

Your friend,

(s) Howes Meade

HM:jy

American Federation of Labor

January 17, 1947

Joseph A. Padway, Esq.
General Counsel
American Federation of Labor
736 Hoven Building
Washington, D. C.

Dear Judge:

I transmit herewith two copies of all the anti-labor bills that I have been able to secure up to date.

As several thousand bills were introduced in the first few days of the Congress, the Government Printing Office fell way behind and they have not quite caught up as yet.

I appreciate your offer of cooperation, as expressed in your letter of January 11, by furnishing me copies of your analyses of the bills. It will be a great help to me.

I am sending the bills to your Washington office as I suppose you will have your assistants make the analyses, and I am also forwarding a copy of this letter to you in Miami in order that you may know that the bills are in their possession.

The only bill that I have not been able to secure is H. R. 1046, introduced by Mr. Hoffman of Michigan - A bill to amend Sections 203 (52 Stat.1060) and 216 (52 Stat. 1069) of title 29 of the U. S. Code, the same being the Fair Labor Standards Act of 1938. Referred to the Committee on Education and Labor.

With best wishes, I am

Sincerely yours,

H/a
Encs.

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee

P. S. I am forwarding the bills under separate cover.

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 3870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL.

Washington 1, D. C.

January 17, 1947

TO THE ORGANIZERS OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

I enclose copy of an official communication which I sent to the representatives of National and International Unions, the Departments of the American Federation of Labor, State Federations of Labor, City Central Bodies and Federal Labor Unions. Will you please arrange to render all service possible in this particular matter and to cooperate with the organizations named to the fullest extent of your ability for the expressed purpose of carrying out the urgent request made in the official communication I am bringing to your attention?

I would not appeal to you in this way if it were not for the fact that we are close to the picture here in Washington and fully understand the urgency of the situation and the need for action.

Fraternally yours,

William Green

President,
American Federation of Labor

ds

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 3870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL.

Executive Council
President, William Green
Secretary-Treasurer, George Meany
A. F. of L. Building, Washington, D. C.

First Vice-President, William L. Hutcheson,
Carpenters' Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.
Second Vice-President, Matthew Woll,
Fifth Vice-President, Geo. M. Harrison,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cincinnati, O.
Sixth Vice-President, Daniel J. Tobin,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Seventh Vice-President, Harvey C. Brown
Eighth Vice-President, W. D. Mahon,
Ninth Vice-President, Felix H. Knight,
Tenth Vice-President, W. C. Birthright,
Eleventh Vice-President, W. D. Honsley,
Twelfth Vice-President, Dan W. Tracy,
Thirteenth Vice-President, John L. Lewis,
United Mine Workers' Bldg., Washington, D. C.

Washington 1, D. C.
January 17, 1947

TO THE PAID ORGANIZER OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

I enclose copy of an official communication which I sent to the representatives of National and International Unions, the Departments of the American Federation of Labor, State Federations of Labor, City Central Bodies and Federal Labor Unions. Will you please arrange to render all service possible in this particular matter and to cooperate with the organizations named to the fullest extent of your ability for the expressed purpose of carrying out the urgent request made in the official communication I am bringing to your attention?

I would not appeal to you in this way if it were not for the fact that we are close to the picture here in Washington and fully understand the urgency of the situation and the need for action.

Fraternally yours,

William Green

President,
American Federation of Labor

ds

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Executive Council
President, William Green
Secretary-Treasurer, George Meany
A. F. of L. Building, Washington, D. C.

First Vice-President, William L. Hutcheson,
Carpenters' Bldg., Indianapolis, Ind.
Second Vice-President, Maurice Weis,
570 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y.
Third Vice-President, Joseph N. Weber,
901 Alta Drive, Beverly Hills, Los Angeles, Calif.
Fourth Vice-President, G. M. Bugniazet,
1015 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Fifth Vice-President, Geo. M. Harrison,
Railway Clerks' Bldg., Cincinnati, O.
Sixth Vice-President, Daniel J. Tobin,
222 East Michigan St., Indianapolis, Ind.
Seventh Vice-President, Harry C. Bates,
815 Fifteenth St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Eighth Vice-President, W. D. Mahon,
12th Floor, 1514 Griswold St., Detroit 26, Mich.
Ninth Vice-President, Felix H. Knight,
400-406 Commerce Bldg., Kansas City, Mo.
Tenth Vice-President, W. C. Hutcheson,
Delaware at Twelfth Street, Indianapolis, Ind.
Eleventh Vice-President, W. C. Doherty,
901 A. F. of L. Bldg., Washington, D. C.
Twelfth Vice-President, David Dubinsky,
1710 Broadway, New York, N. Y.
Thirteenth Vice-President, John L. Lewis,
United Mine Workers' Bldg., Washington, D. C.

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 3870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL.

Washington 1, D. C.

January 17, 1947

TO THE OFFICERS OF NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL UNIONS
AND THE DEPARTMENTS OF THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

Dear Sirs and Brothers:

I enclose copy of an official communication which I sent to the representatives of National and International Unions, the Departments of the American Federation of Labor, State Federations of Labor, City Central Bodies and Federal Labor Unions. Will you please assign organizers employed by national and international unions to visit central bodies and locals in their respective districts for the expressed purpose of appealing to them to carry out the urgent request made in the official communication I am bringing to your attention?

I would not appeal to you in this way if it were not for the fact that we are close to the picture here in Washington and fully understand the urgency of the situation and the need for action.

Fraternally yours,

William Green
President,
American Federation of Labor

ds

Mr Meany

1 m c

January 21, 1947

Mr. Edward H. Woyler, Secretary-Treasurer
Kentucky State Federation of Labor
1402 Washington Building
Louisville 2, Kentucky

Dear Sir and Brother:

I am in receipt of your letter of January 15, regarding anti-labor legislation, and in which you enclose copies of letters you received from Senator Cooper and Congressmen Morton and Meade of Kentucky.

I am very much pleased because you sent me the information contained in the letters addressed to you by these members of Congress, and I have transmitted it to our Legislative Committee as it will be a valuable key when they contact these men.

Again thanking you for your thoughtfulness and diligence in this matter, I am

Fraternally yours,

President
American Federation of Labor

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Central Labor Council of Santa Clara County

January 22, 1947

Mr. J. E. Sullivan
8215 Ingleside
Chicago, Illinois

Dear Sir and Brother:

In reply to your undated letter suggesting that something be done before it is too late against all the crippling legislation affecting labor, I wish to advise that we have been most alert in regard to this matter and several months before the last election we advised all our members of the records of the members of Congress in order that they might vote intelligently in the November 5th elections.

We have also communicated with all our affiliated organizations requesting them to have their individual members communicate with their Representatives in Congress in order that the Congressmen may realize that they were not elected by their constituents to pass anti-labor laws.

I have also called upon our organizations to hold mass meetings, and upon our affiliated organizations to detail all of their representatives to address meetings of labor organizations.

We are doing everything possible to maintain the hard-earned gains made by labor over a long period of years.

Fraternally yours,

President
American Federation of Labor

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TELEPHONE COLUMBIA 8870

Central Labor Council of Santa Clara County

AFFILIATED WITH THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

MEETS EVERY FRIDAY EVENING

SAN JOSE, CALIFORNIA

LABOR TEMPLE, 72 NORTH SECOND STREET

January 23, 1947

RECEIVED
JAN 27 1947

Executive Board Members
American Federation of Labor
A.F.of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sirs And Brothers:

In a letter from William Green, President American Federation of Labor addressed to this Council, under date of December 14, 1946, urging all Central Bodies to communicate with their Congressmen, urging them to stand by Labor, in the exercise of its right to join and maintain Unions, and to enjoy the full freedom and Liberty guaranteed by the Constitution of the United States, this request has been complied with, but the deligates to this Council instructed me to send a communication to the Executive Board of the American Federation of Labor, urging this body to, get behind this movemant, and assist in opposing all anti-labor legislation.

Fraternally yours,

Central Labor Council of
Santa Clara County, A.F.of L.

LeRoy Pette, Secretary

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Mr Hushing

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January 23, 1947

January 23, 1947

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y yours,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

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January 23, 1947

Mr. Allan Kaplan
356 - 11th Avenue
Paterson 47, New Jersey

Dear Sir:

This will acknowledge receipt of your post-card of recent date, and I wish to advise that President Green will make our statement on labor bills now pending in the Congress during the week of February 17, and it will be available, of course, upon application to the Senate Committee on Labor and Public Welfare.

Very truly yours,

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

H/a

New York Federation of Post Office Clerks

January 23, 1947

Mr. Edward H. Moyler, Secretary-Treasurer
Kentucky State Federation of Labor
1402 Washington Building
Louisville 2, Kentucky

Dear Sir and Brother:

I am in receipt of your letter of January 14 and I think that it would be advisable that correspondence from local unions, their legislative committees, and individual members should begin now as the Senate Committee on Labor and Public Welfare began its hearings today and they are to run for about six weeks. Labor is to be heard last, beginning the week of February 17.

No doubt a bill will be reported from the Committee and if it is an objectionable one we will, of course, immediately communicate with our organizations and request them to take further action.

With thanks for your interest in these matters, I am

Fraternally yours,

President
American Federation of Labor

Patrick J. Gorman
Secretary.

Ha.
ociu-2

New York Federation of Post Office Clerks

LOCAL No. 10 NATIONAL FEDERATION OF POST OFFICE CLERKS

Affiliated with

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

CENTRAL TRADES AND LABOR COUNCIL OF GREATER NEW YORK

NEW YORK STATE FEDERATION OF POST OFFICE CLERKS

JOINT CONFERENCE OF AFFILIATED POSTAL EMPLOYEES OF GREATER NEW YORK AND VICINITY

CENTRAL UNION LABEL COUNCIL

206 WEST 23rd STREET - NEW YORK 11, N. Y.

Phone CHelsea 3-0919

January 24,1947.

RECEIVED
JAN 25 1947

Mr. William Green, President,
American Federation of Labor,
Washington, D.C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

At the January membership meeting of the above-named local cognizance was taken of the announced intention of some of the present members of Congress to pass restrictive labor laws. The following motion was adopted:

> "That President William Green of the American Federation of Labor be informed that Local 10 of the National Federation of Post Office Clerks will actively support the American Federation of Labor in its attempts to prevent the enactment by Congress of restrictive labor laws, and also, that the President of the American Federation of Labor be requested to call a meeting of the national officers of the Railroad Brotherhoods and the C.I.O. at which they would be asked to act jointly with the A.F. of L in opposing the passage of restrictive labor laws.

Fraternally yours,

Patrick J. Fitzgerald

Patrick J. Fitzgerald,
Secretary.

Ephraim Handman,
President.

Mr. Durkin

INTERNATIONAL GLOVE WORKERS UNION OF AMERICA

January 27, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A.F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

****

As regards to your information about the hostile Congress towards organized labor, I am following your advise and am keeping our local unions posted on what kind of proceedure they should follow, so that we can combat the congressional hostile legislative program.

With kind personal regards and best wishes, I am

Fraternally yours,

(Signed) Thomas Durian
President
Int'l Glove Workers Union
of America

INTERNATIONAL PRINTING PRESSMEN &
ASSISTANTS' UNION of NORTH AMERICA

A PROGRESSIVE AND HUMANITARIAN ORGANIZATION OFFERING SERVICE AND
PROTECTION TO ALL PRESSROOM WORKERS OF NORTH AMERICA, OPERAT-
ING A TECHNICAL TRADE SCHOOL, HOME FOR SUPERANNUATED
MEMBERS, SANATORIUM, THE AMERICAN PLAN FOR
OLD AGE PENSION AND DEATH BENEFITS

HEADQUARTERS
PRESSMEN'S HOME, TENNESSEE
OFFICE OF GEORGE L. BERRY, PRESIDENT

January 27, 1947

RECEIVED
JAN 28 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

This is to acknowledge yours of the seventeenth to which you attached official communication sent to representatives of National and International Unions, etc., under the same date dealing with legislative matters and thank you for it. Be assured of our whole-hearted cooperation.

With kind regards, I am

Sincerely and fraternally,

GLB-dw

President.

Mr Thackery

Missoula, Montana. R # 1
Jan. 28, 1947

RECEIVED
FEB 3 0 1947

Dear Congressmen from Montana;

Am taking this means of addressing you jointly but in a personal manner, calling upon you to take active action and to vote against any and all Anti-labor legislation.

Reasons. I do not believe labor troubles will ever be solved by laws I believe only TIME itself will settle them better as we become better educated and understand each other--Labor and Industry. I believe our recent wave of strikes was a result of war conditions, a struggle against living costs and shortages.

Government bungling. To me, a layman in such affairs, the government bungled in enforcing it's own regulations as follows;

(a) Froze wages and Labor as well as prices. OK?

(b) Then ship builders and aircraft makers squacked about difficulties in inducing workers into their plants. OK?

(c) Next the government REVERSED itself and told these builders to offer HIGHER pay. OK?

(D) Was NOT that the very start of our troubles? Workers flocked into those places, leaving dopes like me "froze". OK?

(e) WHERE was the first wave of strikes from? Not those High pay jobs but from those industries hard hit by inequalities which were being drained of their trained workers, causing raw material shortages whidh in turn threatened lay off, sometimes called absenteeism as a cover-up. OK?

(f) Not only were those strikes in demand of living wages but an affort to keep their industry's status quo. That is why many Employers gladly gave increases. Strikes were also a protest again stripping local stores of necessities to OVERSTOCK stores where higher wages existed. OK?

(g) And now as a face saving gesture the government dizzy and befogged seizes upon Hohn Lewis case to muzzle Labor's efforts to adjust itself to peace conditions. That is, their Constitutional Right, since war controls were scrapped. OK?

I believe that Labor voted the Republicans into power as the only way to stop REGIMENTING, and NOT a signal to tear down the hard won rights of workers.

I honestly believe that IF ERRORS do exist Unions and Industry MUST correct them by themselves. I object to a Congress of lawyers as we now have hogtie Labor over to amonopoly of lawyers, I would rather see a picket line than a picket fence with smoking ruins behind it. And that's what Anti-Labor Legislation will provoke. We saw enough of Prohibition tragedies but this is EVERY MAN'S BREAD.

Yours truly,

Archie R Randles

January 28, 1947

Mr. LeRoy Potts, Secretary
Central Labor Council of Santa Clara County
Labor Temple, 72 North Second Street
San Jose, California

Dear Sir and Brother:

I am pleased to note by your letter dated January 23rd that the Central Labor Council of Santa Clara County is responding to the request I made in a communication sent all Central Bodies recently. If the individual members of Unions affiliated with your Central Labor Council of Santa Clara County would write the members in Congress urging them to oppose anti-labor legislation it would have a most profound effect on the members of Congress.

Be assured that the Executive Council of the American Federation of Labor is concentrating its efforts to prevail upon members of Congress to oppose the enactment of anti-labor legislation. The Executive Council is meeting on January 29th and special consideration will be given to the legislative problem at this meeting of the Council. I expect to appear before committees of the Congress in behalf of the Executive Council and the American Federation of Labor in opposition to anti-labor legislation now being considered by the members of Congress.

Fraternally yours,

TC/bk
IOPU #67 AFL

President
American Federation of Labor

mr

West Virginia State Federation of Labor

Organized April 30, 1903 - Reorganized March 12, 1939

AFFILIATED WITH AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

TELEPHONE 36-411 - EXECUTIVE OFFICE, 807-8 DOMINION BLDG.
804 QUARRIER STREET

CHARLESTON 1, WEST VIRGINIA

R. A. CARTER
PRESIDENT

VOLNEY ANDREWS
SECRETARY-TREASURER

BOARD MEMBERS

DISTRICT 1
D. P. KEPNER
[illegible]
PARKERSBURG, W. VA.

DISTRICT 2
WILLIAM ALEXANDER
901 HARRISON HIGHWAY
CHARLESTON, W. VA.

DISTRICT 3
M. M. DAVIS
25 JAMES ST.
KENOVA, W. VA.

DISTRICT 4
B. H. STEPHENSON
GENERAL DELIVERY
MILTON, W. VA.

DISTRICT 5
HARRY O. WHITE
ROUTE NO. 1
WINFIELD, W. VA.

January 28, 1947

RECEIVED
JAN 29 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

I received your circular letter concerning the activities of members of various organizations to use their influence against the passage of certain bills which you mentioned in your letter.

I wish to inform you that I shall be only too glad to do everything I possibly can to prevent any action by our representatives from West Virginia that would have any tendency to pass these bills.

I am writing both senators and congressmen requesting them to use their influence against any action on these bills which would cause them to become enacted by Congress.

Fraternally yours,

Tom Cairns

Tom Cairns, Organizer
American Federation of Labor

TC/bk
IOEU #67 AFL

MINNIE FRANK SELVIN 2080 NIGHTOWER DRIVE LOS ANGELES 28, CALIFORNIA

January 29, 1947

Gentlemen:

Two anti-labor bills have already been introduced in the Utah State legislature, one outlawing secondary boycotts and the second would make it illegal for unions to strike over jurisdictional issues. Other bills are expected, so will you please send all available literature and information on these matters which might be helpful in fighting them.

Airmail material immediately to: ~~XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~
Senator S. J. Selvin
Hotel Utah
Salt Lake City, Utah

Mr. Reuther
1-31-47
mr

UNIVERSAL CITY
JAN 29
3 PM
1947
CALIF.

Personal Mailing Card

RECEIVED JAN 31 1947

American Federation of Labor

Washington

D.C.

AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

LONG DISTANCE TELEPHONE NATIONAL 5870-1-2-3-4
CABLE ADDRESS AFEL

Washington 1, D. C.

January 30, 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
Alcazar Hotel
Miami, Florida

Dear Mr. Green:

Herewith the anti-labor bills, now pending in Congress, with analyses and comments as promised for next week.

I am also mailing sufficient copies of the analyses and comments for the Executive Council members.

Sincerely

W. C. Hushing, Chairman
National Legislative Committee
American Federation of Labor

Mr Schoenberg

AMALGAMATED MEAT CUTTERS AND BUTCHER WORKMEN OF NORTH AMERICA

Affiliated with A. F. of L.

Local Union No. 573

January 31, 1947

Mr, Wm. Green, Pres.
American Fedaration of Labor
Washington, D.C.

FEB 4 1947

Dear Brother:

At our last meeting, Friday January 17, 1947, the Executive Board of our Local Union #573 of the AMC & BW of NA reported on the various anti-labor bills now being discussed in both houses of Congress. And after a discussion on this report, we the members of Local #573 have concluded that should these bills be allowed to pass and become law, it means the destruction of the Labor Movement. All gains made by labor in the last fourteen years of progressive government will be nullified.

These bills, pushed by the reactionary clique of Republicans and Poll-Tax Democrats, are promoted by the National Association of Manufacturers, the most vicious enemy of all labor.

Not only is labor concerned with these problems, but it means lowering of the standard of living of the American people in general, and a definite tendency towards Fascism and destruction of Democracy in the United States.

We feel that to meet this unwarranted attack Labor must unite. No Personal and Political disagreements in the ranks of labor should be permitted to stand in the way. We therefore urge you, as President of our great Federation, to call on the heads of the other Labor Organizations such as the UMWA, the R.R. Brotherhodds, the CIO, the IAM, and all Independent Unions to discuss with them a program of action against the united front of the open shop employers and their representatives in Congress. Labor must moblize all its strength to meet this brazen attack.

A legislative Conference of Labor would consider these problems and work out a program of action to stop this crusade against the American people and once more assert our vigilance for real Democracy in our country.

Fraternally yours,

Members of Local #573

International Brotherhood of Paper Makers

Affiliated with American Federation of Labor, Union Label Trades Department, Metal Trades and Textile Councils of Canada, Pennsylvania Federation of Labor and Wisconsin Federation of Labor

MATTHEW J. BURNS, PRESIDENT

PAUL L. PERALTA, 1ST VICE-PRES.
30 Sheridan Ave., Albany 1, N. Y.

FRANK P. BARRY, 2ND VICE-PRES.
30 Sheridan Ave., Albany 1, N. Y.

JOHN W. RAUEN, 3RD VICE-PRES.
[illegible]

J. ARTHUR BOURQUE, 4TH VICE-PRES.
[illegible]

JOSEPH KUPP, SEC.-TREAS.

RUSSELL DRUMMOND, 5TH VICE-PRES.
[illegible]

JOHN B. JONES, 6TH VICE-PRES.
[illegible]

WILLIAM M. BILL, 7TH VICE-PRES.
[illegible]

DAVID S. LARNER, AUDITOR
[illegible]

30 SHERIDAN AVENUE, ALBANY 1, N.Y.

Dial 5-7388

OFFICE OF THE PRESIDENT

January 31, 1947

FEB 3 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington 1, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

We have your communication of the 17th instant at hand, in which you enclosed a copy of a letter that you have addressed to the Officers of National and International Unions, State Federations, etc., calling upon all labor to make all possible effort to combat the proposed anti-union legislation now being considered by Congress. This letter was dated January 17th also.

I have been instructed to write you this morning requesting that you send me (addressed to the undersigned) thirty-five (35) copies of the above letter, as I wish to place a copy in the hands of every one of our Regional Officers and Field Men at as early a date as possible.

Fraternally yours

W. R. Smith.

WRS:mh

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William R. Smith, Representative
International Brotherhood of
Paper Makers

KENTUCKY STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

EXPLANATION

To: President Green
From: W. C. Hushing
Date: January 31, 1947

I have made arrangements for you to be the first Labor witness before the Senate Committee on Education and Public Welfare on pending labor bills.

You are to appear at 10 A. M., February 18, 1947, and you are allotted two and one-half hours. You must file a brief at least twenty-four hours prior to your appearance.

The Committee wishes seventy-five copies of the brief and a like number of a summary. The brief is not to be read to the Committee, but you are to speak on the bills for one and a quarter hours, without interruption, and then there will be an hour and a quarter of questioning.

Phil Murray will be the next witness the afternoon of February 18.

I am very pleased with the response from the local unions. In order to follow through and to get full support from Kentucky labor in defeating anti-labor legislation in the Congress of the United States you will agree with me, I am sure, that all correspondence from local unions and their legislative committees and members, should be at the most advantageous time.

Therefore, may I urge that either you or legislative representatives keep me posted as to the most advantageous time for me to advise our Kentucky locals and members to write their Congressmen, and/or Senators. I am sure that on three to four days notice I can get at least 5,000 letters out of Kentucky, and I mean personal letters.

E/a

With best wishes and kindest personal regards, I am

Fraternally yours,

Robert K. Wyler,
Secretary-Treasurer

RKW:bw

Mr. Johnsburg

HARRY P. PETTY, PRESIDENT
EDWARD H. WEYLER, SECRETARY-TREASURER

KENTUCKY STATE FEDERATION OF LABOR

AFFILIATED WITH THE AMERICAN FEDERATION OF LABOR

First Vice President
A. E. KAISER
LOUISVILLE

Second Vice President
LONNIE WEBSTER
LEXINGTON

Third Vice President
ELMER ROTHRING
COVINGTON

Fourth Vice President
MRS. JAMES HARRY
PADUCAH

Fifth Vice President
JAMES J. JOHNSON
GREENSBORO

Sixth Vice President
JOHN E. McKIERNAN
LOUISVILLE

Seventh Vice President
IRA G. THOMPSON
HOPKINSVILLE

Eighth Vice President
FRANK STARRITT
CORBIN

Legislative Committee
ROBT. F. WOERNER, CHAIRMAN
LOUISVILLE

Telephone JAckson 6189 LOUISVILLE 2, KENTUCKY 1402 WASHINGTON BUILDING

January 14, 1947

RECEIVED
JAN 16 1947

Mr. William Green, President
American Federation of Labor
A. F. of L. Building
Washington, D. C.

Dear Sir and Brother:

Some time ago I wrote you advising what we were doing in Kentucky relative to mass meetings throughout the state and in organizing legislative committees in each local union.

I am very pleased with the response from the local unions. In order to follow through and to get full support from Kentucky Labor in defeating anti-labor legislation in the Congress of the United States you will agree with me, I am sure, that all correspondence from local unions and their legislative committees and members, should be at the most advantageous time.

Therefore, may I urge that either you or legislative representatives keep me posted as to the most advantageous time for me to advise our Kentucky locals and members to write their Congressmen and/or Senators. I am sure that on three to four days notice I can get at least 5,000 letters out of Kentucky, and I mean personal letters.

With best wishes and kindest personal regards, I am

Fraternally yours,

Edw. H. Weyler

Edward H. Weyler,
Secretary-Treasurer

EHW:bw